Artificial Magnets

Magnets that are made by people in the laboratory or factory are called artificial magnets. These are also known as man-made magnets, which are stronger than the natural magnets. Artificial magnets can be made in various shapes and dimensions. Bar magnets, U-shaped magnets, horseshoe magnets, cylindrical magnets, disc magnets, ring magnets and electromagnets are some examples of artificial magnets. Artificial magnets are usually made up of iron, nickel, cobalt, steel, etc. Alloy of the metals Neodynium and Samarium are also used to make artificial magnets.

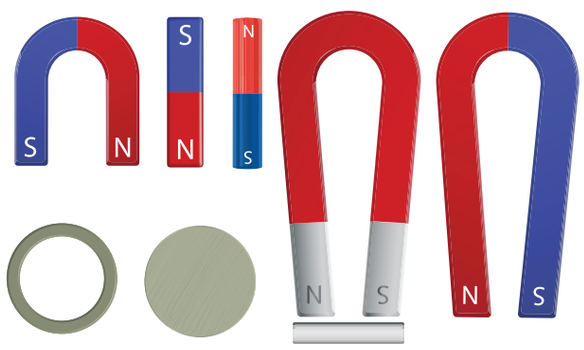


Figure 7.2 Artificial magnets

Table 7.1 Difference between natural and artificial magnets

Natural Magnets	Artificial Magnets
These are found in nature and have irregular shapes and dimensions.	These are man-made magnets. They can be made in different shapes and dimensions.
The strength of a natural magnet is well determined and difficult to change.	Artificial magnets can be made with required and specific strength.
These are long lasting magnets.	Their properties are time bound.
They have a less usage.	They have a vast usage in day to day life.

Know Your Scientist



William Gilbert laid the foundation for magnetism and suggested that the Earth has a giant bar magnet. William Gilbert was born on 24th May 1544. He was the first man who performed the systematic research on the properties of the lodestone (magnetic iron ore) and published his findings in the influential 'De Magnete' (The Magnet).

7.2 Magnetic Properties

The properties of a magnet can be explained under the following headings.

- Attractive property
- Reflective property
- Directive property

7.2.1 Attractive Property

A magnet always attracts materials like iron, cobalt and nickel. To understand the attractive property of a magnet let us do an experiment.

Activity 1

Take some iron filings in a paper and place a magnet near them. Do you see the iron filings being attracted by the magnet? In which part of the magnet they are attracted?



You can observe here that the iron filings are attracted near the ends of the magnet. These ends are called poles of a magnet. This shows that the attractive property of a magnet is more at the poles. One pole of the magnet

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